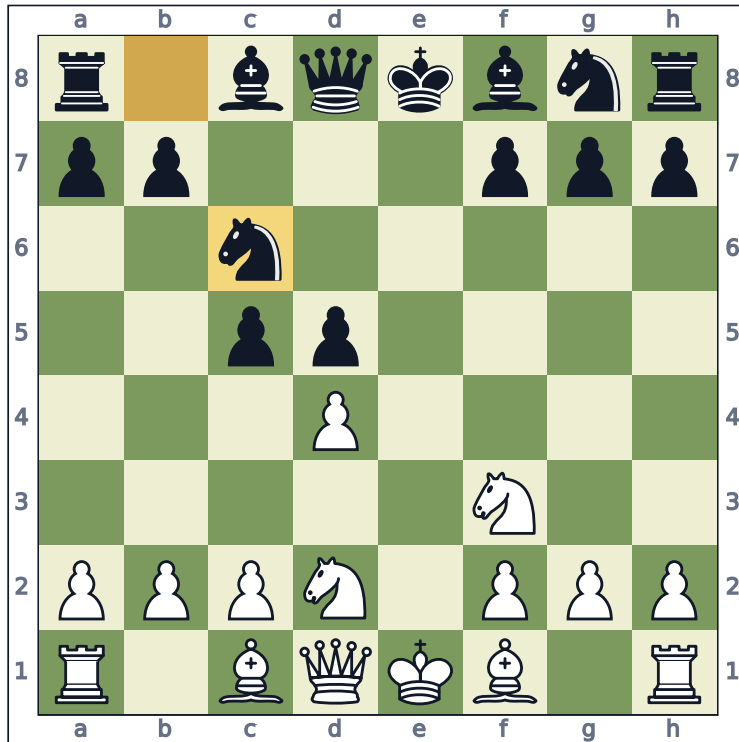


## FRENCH DEFENSE

# French Defense

ECO C09 | 2 named lines in this code



*Featured opening position - gold marks the last move*

## IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

## ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.40 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

## GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

## WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C09 covers French Defense. Black builds a d5-e6 center and accepts a temporarily restricted c8 bishop in exchange for a clear attack on White's center. The diagram uses the featured line French Defense: Tarrasch Variation, Open System, Main Line.

## DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 c5 4. exd5 exd5 5. Ngf3 Nc6

## UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

# What both sides are trying to achieve

**WHITE'S GOALS**

Use the space advantage, support the e5 chain when it exists, and develop before beginning a kingside attack.

**BLACK'S GOALS**

Challenge d4 with ...c5, attack e5 with ...f6 when sound, and solve the c8 bishop deliberately.

**PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING**

...c5 is the basic break; ...f6 is the second. White often uses c3, f4-f5, or queenside play depending on the structure.

**PIECE MAP**

White's e5 pawn can gain space but needs support. Black's bad bishop often becomes active after ...b6 and ...Ba6 or after exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

**WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG**

Both sides can misjudge the pawn chain: attack its base and calculate breaks rather than attacking where the chain is strongest. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

**POSITION SNAPSHOT**

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on c5, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5.

**WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?**

A sound, excellent defense with clear plans and rich counterplay, though cramped positions require patience.

## COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

# Every named C09 line

This section preserves all 2 names and defining routes assigned to C09 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

**001 French Defense: Tarrasch Variation, Open System, Main Line**

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 c5 4. exd5 exd5 5. Ngf3 Nc6

**002 French Defense: Tarrasch Variation, Open System, Main Line**

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 c5 4. exd5 exd5 5. Ngf3 Nc6 6. Bb5 Bd6 7. dxc5 Bxc5 8. O-O Ne7 9. c3